

Come, go, bring, and take

Learner workbook

Describe movement from a clear point of view.

Understand the distinction

Come often describes movement toward the speaker, listener, or an agreed meeting place. Go commonly describes movement away or toward another place. Bring and take describe similar movement with a person or thing.

The viewpoint can be a future location. On the phone, I am coming to your office treats the listener as the destination. Bring your notes to our meeting uses the shared meeting as the reference point. Context can make more than one choice natural.

Compare the patterns

TOWARD US

Can you come to my desk?

The speaker is the destination.

ANOTHER PLACE

I need to go to the bank.

The bank is another destination.

WITH SOMETHING

Please bring your notes to our meeting.

The notes move toward the shared meeting.

Read each example and notice how its form changes the meaning. Use these distinctions to choose your answers on the following pages.

Check your understanding

Circle one answer for each question. There is one correct choice among the options shown. Check the answer key after choosing.

1. You are at home inviting a friend. Complete: Please ___ over.

- A. take
- B. go
- C. come

2. You are leaving home for class. Complete: I must ___ my book with me.

- A. take
- B. taken
- C. taking

3. Can come refer to the listener's location?

- A. Yes: I am coming to your office.
- B. Yes. Come always means movement away from both people.
- C. No. Come can only mean movement to the speaker.

Choose the best response

Choose the response that fits the situation. Check both its meaning and its grammar.

4. You are inviting someone to your house and asking them to carry a drink there. Which wording fits?

- A. Come to my house for lunch. Please bringing a drink.
- B. Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.
- C. Come my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

Review your choices

Use the answer explanations on the next page. If you chose a different answer, find the detail that makes it unsuitable and try the question again.

Practice online

The web lesson gives feedback for the option you select and lets you try again. No written response is required.

Answers and explanation

1. C. come

The friend moves toward you.

2. A. take

You carry the book away from your current location.

3. A. Yes: I am coming to your office.

The viewpoint can be the listener or a shared destination.

4. B. Come to my house for lunch. Please bring a drink.

Come and bring use the host's destination as the viewpoint.

Continue learning

Web lesson and related topics: englishladder.com/grammar-concepts/concept-11.html